Topic 30 — Environmental Literature & Awareness

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Environmental Literature | Environmental Education (पर्यावरण शिक्षा) | Environmental Awareness (पर्यावरण जागरूकता) | Environmental Communication

Sources baked in: NCERT; MoEFCC schemes; NEP 2020; UNESCO ESD; Tbilisi 1977; UPPCS/UPSC PYQs **Weight:** ★★★ High — Carson/Hardin/Brundtland traps; ECO Club; Art 51A(g); LiFE **Last verified:** August 2026

Current Affairs (this topic)

- Book–author pairs (Carson, Fukuoka, etc.) stay fixed; new award themes are light CA.
- Silent Spring ≠ Silent Valley (साइलेंट वैली) (movement).

30.1 Environmental Literature

Identity: Carson / Hardin / Limits / Brundtland | Author ↔ work matching

- **Environmental literature** includes books and landmark reports that shaped ecological thought and policy.
- **Rachel Carson, *Silent Spring* (1962):** exposed DDT/pesticide harm to birds, food chains, and health — triggered the modern environmental movement.
- **Garrett Hardin, "Tragedy of the Commons" (1968):** argued individuals overuse shared resources (pasture, fisheries, air) for private gain.
- **Club of Rome, *The Limits to Growth* (1972):** modelled exponential growth hitting planetary resource limits — **not** the Brundtland Report.
- **Brundtland Commission, *Our Common Future* (1987):** defined and **popularised Sustainable Development** — meeting present needs without compromising future generations.
- **W.M. Adams, *Green Development* (first edition 1990):** environment and sustainability in the developing world.
- **Masanobu Fukuoka** was a Japanese farmer-philosopher who pioneered **natural farming** and re-vegetation of desertified lands.
- **Aldo Leopold, *A Sand County Almanac* (1949):** "Land Ethic" — moral duty to the biotic community.
- **Paul Ehrlich, *The Population (जनसंख्या) Bomb* (1968):** population growth vs resource limits debate.
- **Indian voices:** Gandhi (गांधी) *Hind Swaraj (स्वराज)* (हिंद स्वराज) (1909) — restraint vs reckless industrialism; Tagore/Shantiniketan — nature-linked education; Bahuguna — "ecology (पारिस्थितिकी) is permanent economy"; CSE (Anil Agarwal, Sunita Narain) — *Down To Earth*.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q51

Assertion (A): Sustainable Development was popularised by the Brundtland Report. Reason (R): The Brundtland Report is also known as "The Limits to Growth".

Options: A. Both true; R does not explain A B. A false, R true C. Both true; R explains A D. A true, R false

Show answer

Ans: D — Brundtland = *Our Common Future* 1987. Limits to Growth = Club of Rome 1972.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2020, Q17

Silent Spring (1962) was written by:

Options: A. Carolyn Merchant B. Karl Marx C. Rachel Carson D. Rajgopalan

Show answer

Ans: C

Work	Author/Body	Year
Silent Spring	Rachel Carson	1962
Tragedy of the Commons	Garrett Hardin	1968
Limits to Growth	Club of Rome	1972
Our Common Future	Brundtland / WCED	1987
Green Development	W.M. Adams	1990

> **Logic:** Carson ≠ Hardin. Brundtland ≠ Limits to Growth. Fukuoka = natural farming.

30.2 Environmental Education

Identity: Tbilisi 1977 | NGC/ECO Club | NEP 2020 ESD | Formal + non-formal

- **Environmental Education (EE)** builds knowledge, attitudes, skills, and participation for environmental protection.
- **Stockholm 1972** (स्टॉकहोम सम्मेलन) put EE on the global agenda; **Tbilisi Declaration (1977)** became the first intergovernmental EE framework.
- **Rio 1992 Agenda 21 Chapter 36** called for reorienting education toward sustainable development.
- **NEP 2020** integrates environmental awareness and ESD across stages through experiential, multidisciplinary learning.
- **National Green Corps (NGC) (नेशनल ग्रीन कॉर्प्स) / ECO Clubs (MoEFCC):** school/college clubs for plantation, waste management, biodiversity surveys, energy audits.
- **Paryavaran Mitra (मित्र -):** CEE Ahmedabad (अहमदाबाद) + MoEFCC — student/teacher green ambassadors.

- **Green Skill Development Programme (GSDP), 2017:** MoEFCC + Skill Ministry — vocational green skills.
- Formal EE = curriculum; non-formal = ECO Clubs, camps, community programmes.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q132

Agenda-21 of Rio Summit (1992) is related to—

Options: A. Sustainable Development B. Polluter Pays C. Environmental Education D. Ozone Layer

Show answer

Ans: A — Agenda 21 is the SD action plan (Chapter 36 covers EE as one part).

Year	Milestone
1972	Stockholm — EE on agenda
1977	**Tbilisi Declaration**
1992	Agenda 21 Ch. 36
~2001–02	NGC / ECO Club national push
2017	GSDP
2020	NEP 2020 ESD integration

> **Logic:** ECO Club = MoEFCC NGC. Tbilisi = EE; Stockholm = UNEP (संयुक्त राष्ट्र पर्यावरण कार्यक्रम) birth — different milestones.

30.3 Environmental Awareness

Identity: Art 51A(g) | NEAC | Van Mahotsav | LiFE | Behaviour change

- **Environmental awareness** is public understanding and concern that drives behaviour change and civic action.
- **Article 51A(g)** (42nd (42वां) Amendment, 1976): Fundamental Duty to protect and improve forests, lakes, rivers, and wildlife — pairs with **Art 48A** (state duty).
- **National Environment Awareness Campaign (NEAC):** MoEFCC-funded NGO/school campaigns since the 1980s.
- **Van Mahotsav:** tree-plantation week in **July**, popularised by **K.M. Munshi (1950)**.
- **LiFE Mission:** idea at **COP26 (2021)**; launched **June 2022** — 75 pro-planet lifestyle actions (awareness/nudge, not school curriculum).
- International awareness anchors: **World Environment Day (विश्व पर्यावरण दिवस) (5 June)**, **Earth Day (पृथ्वी दिवस) (22 April)** — full date list in Topic 31.
- EE = structured institutional learning; awareness = broad public campaigns and duties.

Eco-mark, greenwashing (ग्रीनवॉशिंग), and related awareness facts

- **Eco-mark / ECOMARC** is India's eco-labelling scheme launched in **1991** by the Government of India and administered by the **Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS)**.
- Eco-mark identifies **environment-friendly consumer products** that cause least ecosystem (पारिस्थितिकी तंत्र) impact — it is **not** Agmark or a general quality-only mark. Drugs/antibiotics are typically **not** on the Eco-mark notified consumer list in bank teaching.
- **AGMARK** is a quality certification mark for agricultural produce under the **Agricultural Produce (Grading and Marking) Act, 1937**, issued through the Directorate of Marketing and Inspection (Ministry of Agriculture) — **not FAO**.
- **BIS / ISI** marks cover many industrial and consumer products (including mandatory certification for automotive tyres and tubes in classic stems).
- **Greenwashing** means conveying a **false or misleading impression** that a company (कंपनी)'s products or practices are eco-friendly.
- **Greendex** (ग्रीनडेक्स) (National Geographic / GlobeScan) measures **environmentally sustainable consumer behaviour** across countries — not carbon-credit sales volume.
- **Plachimada** (Palakkad, **Kerala**) became a landmark local struggle against groundwater contamination linked to a Coca-Cola bottling plant.
- Australia's **Green Army (सेना)** was a youth environment-works programme; it closed on **30 June 2018**.
- **GACSA (Global Alliance for Climate-Smart Agriculture)** has **non-binding** membership. It is **not** an outcome of the Paris 2015 Climate Summit, and India was **not** instrumental in creating it.
- **Conservation Agriculture** principles are **minimum tillage**, **soil cover with crop residues**, and **crop rotation / sequencing**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q139

LiFE: (1) launched June 2022 (2) idea proposed at COP-25 Madrid

Options: A. Only 2 B. Neither C. Both D. Only 1

Show answer

Ans: D — Launch true. Idea = **COP26 Glasgow 2021**, not COP-25.

> **Logic:** LiFE = awareness/behaviour campaign. COP-25 Madrid trap is false.

30.4 Environmental Communication

Identity: Science → public | Down To Earth | IEC | Risk communication

- **Environmental communication** transmits environmental science, policy, and risk information accurately and accessibly.
- Bridges scientists/policymakers and citizens — translates AQI, BOD, IPCC (आईपीसीसी) summaries into usable messages.

- **CSE *Down To Earth*** (Anil Agarwal / Sunita Narain): leading Indian env journalism; **Gobar Times** for children.
- **Official channels:** MoEFCC/PIB releases, ISFR summaries, NAPCC documents.
- **KSSP model:** people's science communication during Silent Valley — data → public pressure → policy win.
- **IEC (Information, Education, Communication)** components in Swachh Bharat, Namami Gange (नमामि गंगे), NCAP, plastic-waste rules.
- Digital tools: Mission LiFE app, Sameer (CPCB (केंद्रीय प्रदूषण नियंत्रण बोर्ड) AQI), DIKSHA eco-modules.
- **IPCC** communicates climate science assessments — it is not an MoEFCC-style public awareness campaign body.

Channel	Example
Magazine	Down To Earth
Children's	Gobar Times
Scheme IEC	Namami Gange / Swachh Bharat
People's science	KSSP

> **Logic:** Communication ≠ awareness alone — accurate transmission of science/policy is the core.
